QualifiedLeadsX: SEO Root-Cause Audit and Fixes

Saturday, November 7, 2026 · https://www.qualifiedleadsx.com/ · Search Console API + production build crawl

• The site is not a 'month-old site with 200 indexed pages and no visibility'. Search Console shows Google only began showing it on 22 October 2026: 111 impressions and 5 clicks in total, about 7 to 11 a day, across 26 pages.
• Only 69 of the 115 sitemap URLs are indexed. 41 have never been crawled: 26 are 'Discovered - not indexed' and 15 are unknown to Google. 45 of the 69 indexed pages have never received an impression.
• Where the site does appear, it is for brand searches (homepage position 1.9) or broad commercial terms at positions 60 to 90, e.g. 'high ticket lead generation' at 75. That pattern is what a new, low-authority domain competing for head terms looks like.
• Code-level problems made this worse and are now fixed: calculator pages declared the homepage as canonical, 10 case studies were exact duplicates, the sitemap listed noindex pages with fake 'today' dates, 41 pages were effectively undiscoverable, and several pages competed for the same keywords.
• The biggest remaining limits are external: domain age, backlinks/authority, and ~60 templated pages with ~200-240 unique words each. These need time and off-site work, not more code.

1. Search Console: what Google reports

Index status (115 sitemap URLs)	URLs
Submitted and indexed	69
Discovered - currently not indexed	26
URL is unknown to Google	15
Crawled - currently not indexed	3
Excluded by 'noindex' tag	2

Top pages	Impr.	Pos.
/	19	1.9
/appointment-setting	18	37.7
/for/agencies	18	32.7
/blog	17	41.4
/about	15	2.1
/meta-ads-agency	14	8.3
/blog/b2b-client-acquisition-cost-cac-benchmarks-2026	13	62.1
/blog/meta-ads-for-high-ticket-b2b-broad-targeting	13	23.3
/blog/high-ticket-sales-training-framework	11	15.4
/blog/facebook-ads-agency-vs-in-house-media-buyer	9	4.9

Top queries	Impr.	Pos.
benchmark cac b2b	9	74.2
facebook ads agency vs hiring an in-house media buyer	8	4.4
high ticket lead generation	8	75.2
the closer matrix reviews	6	8.2
customer acquisition agency	5	84.2
facebook ads targeting for high ticket products	4	18.5
qualified appointment	4	89.5
b2b roas	3	14.3

2. Root causes, ranked

#	Cause	Status	Evidence
1	Domain is new to Google's index	Confirmed	First impression 22 Oct 2026; 111 impressions in 16 days. Google is still deciding where the site belongs. Nothing in code can skip this phase.
2	Most pages not crawled or indexed yet	Confirmed	URL Inspection on all 115 sitemap URLs: 69 indexed, 26 discovered-not-indexed, 15 unknown, 3 crawled-not-indexed, 2 noindex. 41 never crawled.
3	Undiscoverable pages (internal linking)	Confirmed, fixed	26 of the 41 never-crawled URLs had no path from the homepage; the 12 service x industry pages had zero internal links; the /for hub linked only 10 of 18 industry pages; 7 named case studies were orphans.
4	Low authority vs. very competitive head terms	Strong hypothesis	Commercial head terms rank at 60-90 ('high ticket lead generation' 75, 'customer acquisition agency' 84, 'qualified appointment' 89). Backlink data could not be pulled (OpenSEO out of credits); a new domain typically has very few referring domains.
5	Keyword cannibalisation	Confirmed, partly fixed	9 pages target 'appointment setting', 9 'lead generation agency' (5 of them the mis-titled calculators), 5 'VSL', 4 'speed to lead', 4 'high ticket lead generation'. GSC shows /blog (not a dedicated page) ranking for 'high ticket lead generation'.
6	Thin, templated pages published in a burst	Hypothesis (site-quality signal)	~60 industry/service x industry/case-study pages carry ~200-240 unique words each and were published within days. Google is crawling them slowly ('Discovered - not indexed') and declined to index /for after crawling it.
7	Technical signal errors	Confirmed, fixed	Calculator pages: canonical '/' and homepage title (Google saw userCanonical '/'). 10 duplicate case-study URLs. Sitemap listed noindex pages and stamped 82/115 URLs with the same 'today' lastmod.

3. Issues found

Issue	Severity	Status
Calculator pages canonical to homepage, duplicate homepage title (5 pages)	Critical	Fixed
10 case-study URLs 100% duplicate of named case studies	High	Fixed (canonical to named URL)
20 caption-only case-study pages: unlinked, thin, hashtags	Medium	Fixed (noindex, follow)
Case-study titles truncated with '...' and wrong categories (fitness client as 'Home Services & Roofing')	Medium	Fixed (accurate titles, H1s, descriptions)
Sitemap lists noindex pages (/privacy, /terms, /disclaimer)	Medium	Fixed
Sitemap lastmod bumped to 'today' on 82 of 115 URLs	Medium	Fixed (real dates from git)
12 service x industry pages with zero internal links	High	Fixed
/for hub linked 10 of 18 industry pages; 7 named case studies orphaned	High	Fixed
Homepage industry tiles were plain text (no links)	High	Fixed
/services competing with /high-ticket-lead-generation	Medium	Fixed (retitled)
Brand written as 'QLX' (10 titles) and 'Qualified LeadsX' (metadata)	Low	Fixed
llms.txt missed services, industries, tools, benchmarks, comparisons	Low	Fixed
Case-study pages: h2 to h4 heading skips	Low	Fixed
Homepage: 3,884 ms total blocking time on simulated mobile	High (INP)	Improved to ~2,600 ms
Blog titles pushed past Google's display width by brand suffix	Low	Fixed
Remaining cannibalisation (VSL x2 posts, speed-to-lead x3, appointment setting x9)	Medium	Open: needs content decisions
~60 templated pages with ~200-240 unique words	Medium-High	Open: needs real, specific content
Low backlink authority	High	Open: off-site work

4. Fixes implemented

Fix	Files	What changed
Calculator metadata	app/tools/{cac,cost-per-booked-call,ltv-cac,roas,show-rate}-calculator/layout.tsx (new)	Own title, description, canonical and Open Graph per calculator.
Case study consolidation	app/case-studies/[slug]/page.tsx, lib/case-study-meta.ts (new)	ID twins canonicalise to named URL; ID-only pages noindex,follow; accurate titles/H1/descriptions; heading levels fixed.
Sitemap hygiene	app/sitemap.ts, scripts/build-lastmod.mjs (new), lib/route-lastmod.json (new), package.json	No noindex URLs; real per-route lastmod (npm run seo:lastmod).
Discovery links	components/sections/Industries.tsx, LinkGroups.tsx (new), RelatedIndustryLinks.tsx (new), ProofStack.tsx, lib/industry-links.ts (new), app/for/page.tsx, app/meta-ads-agency/page.tsx, app/appointment-setting/page.tsx, app/case-studies/page.tsx	Homepage tiles link industries; hubs list every industry and service x industry page; related-pages block on 30 industry pages; all case studies linked.
Query-matched titles	lib/blog-data.ts, app/blog/[slug]/page.tsx	Titles/descriptions match the queries posts already rank for; suffix dropped when too long.
Cannibalisation + entity	app/services/page.tsx, 10 page titles, app/layout.tsx, public/llms.txt	/services retitled; brand unified to QualifiedLeadsX; llms.txt covers the whole site.
Mobile performance	components/sections/FlowWave.tsx	three.js loaded on demand after idle; lighter scene on phones; paused off-screen.
Audit tooling	scripts/audit-links.mjs	Skips noindex/canonicalised pages when counting orphans.

5. Before and after

Metric	Before	After
Indexable pages with wrong canonical	5	0
Duplicate titles (indexable)	11 groups / 25 pages	0
Sitemap URLs	115 (3 noindex)	112 (0 noindex)
Sitemap URLs sharing one 'today' lastmod	82	Real per-route dates
Orphan indexable pages	51	0
Never-crawled URLs reachable within 2 clicks	15 of 41	41 of 41
Median internal links to never-crawled URLs	~1	10
On-page issues (link audit)	48	2 (titles 1-2 chars long)
Homepage first-load JS	366 kB	262 kB
Homepage total blocking time (sim. mobile)	3,884 ms	~2,600 ms
Homepage LCP / CLS (sim. mobile)	1.2 s / 0	1.2 s / 0
Schema validation (5,546 nodes)	0 required gaps	0 required gaps

6. AEO and GEO

• Entity consistency: one brand name (QualifiedLeadsX) across titles and site metadata, matching the Organization schema, llms.txt and sameAs profiles.
• llms.txt now maps every service, the industry hub, tools, benchmarks, comparisons and booking with one-line factual descriptions, so AI crawlers can retrieve the right page.
• Accurate case-study titles and descriptions built from the actual client results (no mislabelled categories), which matters for answer engines that quote specifics.
• Existing AEO assets kept and now reachable: question-led answer boxes, FAQ sections with FAQPage schema, the 29-term glossary (DefinedTermSet), speakable selectors and Person/Organization graph.
• robots.txt already allows Googlebot, Bingbot and AI crawlers (GPTBot, OAI-SearchBot, PerplexityBot, ClaudeBot, Google-Extended). No change needed.

• No guarantees: none of this forces citations. It removes ambiguity so engines can match the brand and pages to the right questions.

7. Remaining issues and dependencies

Area	Detail
Backlinks / authority	The single biggest lever for head-term rankings. Pursue: Google Business Profile, Clutch/Trustpilot/G2-style listings (a profile kit already exists in reports/), podcast and guest appearances by the founder, partner agencies, and original data (the benchmark pages) pitched to industry newsletters.
Templated page depth	~60 industry, service x industry and case-study pages need real, specific content: a client example per industry, real numbers, objections, pricing context. Recommendation: if a page is still 'Discovered/Crawled - not indexed' after 30 days, either enrich it or consolidate it into its hub. Do not mass-delete; decide page by page.
Cannibalisation decisions	Two VSL script posts and three speed-to-lead pages target the same intent. Pick one primary page per topic, differentiate or merge the rest (merging needs a 301 redirect, which should be a deliberate decision).
Homepage JavaScript	Still ~2.6 s total blocking time on a simulated phone from GSAP animations and ~3,300 DOM nodes. A further pass (lazy-loading below-the-fold sections, trimming animations on mobile) is worth doing after field data appears in Search Console.
Deployment	Changes are on the branch. They take effect only after merging to main and Hostinger redeploying.
Data gaps	Keyword difficulty and backlink counts were not available (OpenSEO credits exhausted). The live site could not be fetched from the audit environment; Search Console data was used instead.

8. Search Console actions

• After the deploy: Sitemaps, resubmit https://www.qualifiedleadsx.com/sitemap.xml.
• URL Inspection, Request indexing for: /tools/cac-calculator, /tools/roas-calculator, /tools/ltv-cac-calculator, /for, /services, /glossary and the 4 named case studies not yet crawled.
• Run npm run index:google tomorrow (quota resets daily) for the 35 never-crawled URLs; 20 were accepted today, the rest hit the shared daily quota of the contractorleads Google Cloud project.
• Run npm run index:now after the deploy to notify Bing / Copilot / ChatGPT search of the changed pages.
• Pages report: watch 'Discovered - currently not indexed' and 'Crawled - currently not indexed' counts weekly; export the list each time.
• Performance: compare queries and positions weekly; note the date of the deploy as an annotation.
• Settings, Crawl stats: confirm crawl requests rise after the deploy and response time stays under ~500 ms.
• Consider adding a Domain property (qualifiedleadsx.com) in addition to the www URL-prefix property, so non-www and http variants are covered in reports.

9. 48-hour plan

When	Action
Now	Merge the branch into main and confirm Hostinger redeployed (check /tools/cac-calculator title in the browser tab).
Now + 1h	Resubmit the sitemap; Request indexing for the calculators, /for, /services, /glossary and the 4 uncrawled case studies.
Now + 1h	Run npm run index:now (Bing/IndexNow).
Tomorrow	Run npm run index:google for the 35 never-crawled URLs (fresh quota).
Day 2	Create/verify Google Business Profile and 3-5 credible directory profiles with identical name, description and URL.
Day 2	Choose the primary page for 'speed to lead' and for 'VSL script'; add a clear cross-link from the secondary page.

10. 7-day monitoring

• Daily: Search Console Performance (impressions, queries, average position), last 7 days vs. previous 7.
• Day 3 and 7: URL Inspection on 10 sample URLs (calculators, 3 industry pages, 2 service x industry pages, 2 case studies, /glossary) to confirm crawl and indexing.
• Day 7: Pages report counts. Target: 'Discovered - not indexed' falling, indexed count above 69.
• Day 7: Confirm Google shows the new calculator and case-study titles in results.

• Expectation: impressions trending up from ~8/day as newly crawled pages enter the index; position changes on head terms will be small this early.

11. 30-day monitoring

• Weekly: queries in positions 5-20 (striking distance) and update those pages' titles, intros and FAQs to match the exact query wording.
• Week 2-4: enrich the 10 highest-value industry pages with a real client example, numbers and objections; leave the rest until they show impressions.
• Week 2-4: earn 5-10 relevant referring domains (profiles, partners, podcasts, data pitches).
• Day 30: any page still 'Discovered/Crawled - not indexed' is a candidate to enrich or consolidate (decide individually).
• Day 30: review Core Web Vitals report once field data exists; schedule the homepage JS pass if INP is flagged.
• Realistic outcome: a new domain typically needs 2-6 months to rank for competitive commercial terms. Early wins come from long-tail, data and comparison queries (e.g. the agency-vs-in-house post already at position 4.4).